

Here comes Ubuntu 19.10 (Eoan Ermine)



Ubuntu 19.10, which was released on October 17, 2019, comes with a stack of new features and welcome improvements for the desktop. The new release comes with Linux kernel 5.3, and the GNOME 3.34 desktop environment with new light and dark variants of the Yaru theme. It also now has the capability to run Xwayland apps as root/sudo and the Chromium Web browser as a snap; you can now plug in a USB drive and access it directly from the dock.

Version 19.10 includes the Mozilla Firefox 69 Web browser, the LibreOffice 6.3 office suite, the Mozilla Thunderbird 68 email and news client, and the PulseAudio 13.0 sound system, as default.

It is powered by the latest Linux 5.3 kernel series, which supports AMD Navi GPUs, ARM Komeda displays, Intel Speed Select on Xeon servers, Zhaoxin x86 processors for workstations, new ARM chips, and LZ4 as the default initramfs compression algorithm on all architectures for faster booting. It also comes with new default hardening options enabled in the GCC system compiler for extra security. It includes enhanced K8s capabilities for the edge and AI/ML, OpenStack Train live-migration extensions for easier infrastructure deployments, and more.

In short, Ubuntu 19.10 has lots to offer those looking to upgrade from Ubuntu 19.04, though perhaps not enough to lure anyone away from the current LTS release.

“In the 15 years since the first Ubuntu release, we have seen Ubuntu evolve from the desktop to become the platform of choice across the public cloud, open infrastructure, IoT and AI,” said Mark Shuttleworth, CEO of Canonical. “With the 19.10 release, Ubuntu continues to deliver strong support, security and superior economics to enterprises, developers and the wider community,” he added.

You can download the latest release from <https://ubuntu.com/> or wait till *Open Source For You* bundles it with the December 2019 issue.

Xubuntu 19.10 has also been released along with the Ubuntu 19.10 (Eoan Ermine) operating system. It is a major release with new features

Calibre 4.0 is now available for GNU/Linux, MacOS and Windows

The Calibre open source e-book management app has had a major release after two years. A new version of the cross-platform e-book manager and reader was released on October 4, 2019. Calibre 4.0 is a major update that features a completely rewritten e-book viewer, apart from other changes.

Most of the development time went into migrating Calibre from the previously used QT WebKit to QT WebEngine, as the former is no longer maintained and hence made the migration necessary. Several core components of Calibre had to be rewritten as a consequence, including the e-book viewer, book details and PDF Output.

The content server now has the capability to edit metadata, add/remove books and even convert books to and from all the formats Calibre itself supports. It is now a full-fledged interface to your Calibre libraries.

“It has been two years since Calibre 3.0. This time has been spent mostly in making the Calibre content server even more capable as well as in migrating Calibre itself from Qt WebKit to Qt WebEngine, because the former stops being maintained,” said developer Kovid Goyal.



Calibre 4.0 uses the modern Qt WebEngine content rendering engine, which integrates Chromium’s fast moving Web capabilities into Qt, as a replacement for the now deprecated Qt WebKit.